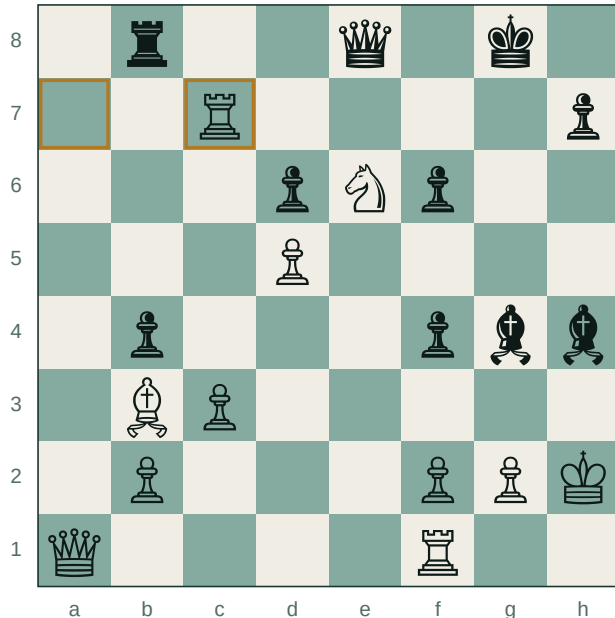


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 28

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 28.Rxc7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

28...Bg3+ 29. Kg1 Qh5 30. Rg7+ Kh8 31. fxc3 fxc3 32. Rf3 Qh2+

28...Bg3+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **29.Kg1**.

29...Qh5 The queen moves from e8 to h5. Recorded reply: **30.Rg7+**.

30...Kh8 The king moves from g8 to h8. Recorded reply: **31.fxc3**.

31...fxg3 The pawn captures the pawn on g3. Recorded reply: **32.Rf3**.

32...Qh2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 22 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by -2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -2: the balance goes from -5 to -7. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on h2. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b3. Check for tactical protection.